

In the duration of the course, you may have facilities such as online interaction with the faculty and help with recruiters (some innovative sites offer this).

Validity of course

A distance learning course will grant you a degree from the uni-

versity where you are undergoing your course once examinations are successfully passed. The individual need not go all the way to the university to give the exam since there may be an exam centre in closer proximity to her. This degree is recognised in industries and is a safe option for those whose career advancement opportunities depend on educational level.

E-learning is the new kid on the block and currently offers you verified certificates for certain courses from different universities for a small fee. However, the validity of these certificates could be called into question as they aren't full-time degrees and may not be accepted by industries as a factor for candidate consideration. Also, in India, a degree always reigns supreme over certificates. At most, the certificates could serve as career enhancement tools, but in the end, a degree is a degree.

Proximity

Distance learning by its very name denotes the remote nature of its courses. However, distance education is constantly evolving and may involve some interaction with tutors and peers directly or through electronic medium.

In the case of e-learning, proximity is dependent on the type of course being undertaken, that is whether it is a supplement to in-campus learning or a complete course in itself.

Guidance

Guidance is an important factor in the dispensation of any kind of education and distance learning courses are designed for proper guidance. The course content is in-depth and instructional in nature and some of the universi-



Learning at your own pace